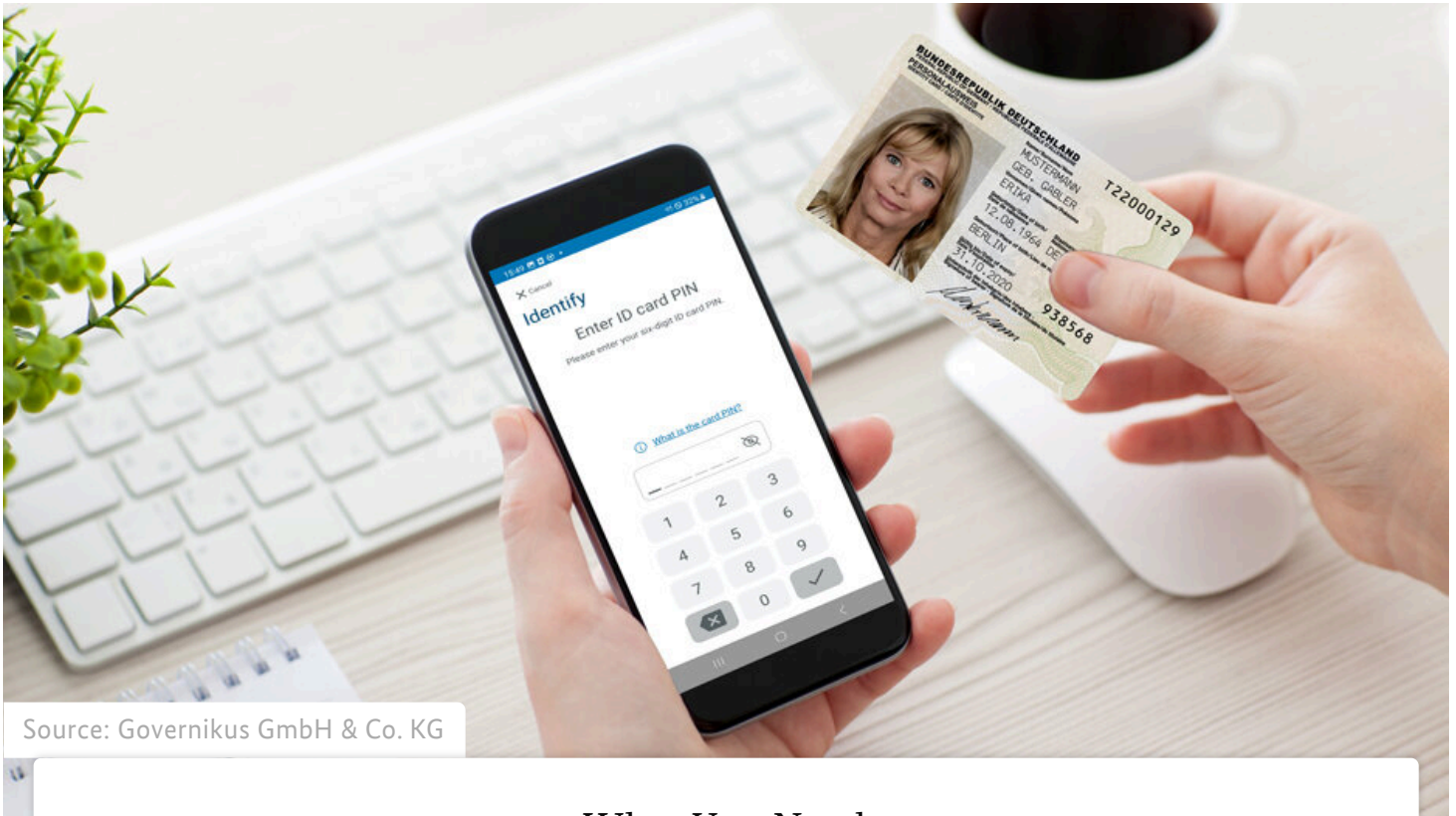




Source: Governikus GmbH & Co. KG

What You Need

Here we explain in detail which requirements must be met so that you can successfully use the eID function.

Requirements

In order to use the eID function successfully, a number of requirements must be met. That is why we explain here in detail what you need to identify yourself securely online.

There are four points you need to check off before you can get started:

1 eID function is activated

The eID function of your ID card or electronic residence permit must be activated. With the eID card, this is activated automatically.



2 Self-selected, six-digit PIN is known

You must enter this PIN each time you authenticate online to enable data transmission.



3 AusweisApp is installed

You can find options to download AusweisApp for your smartpohone, computer oder tablet [here](#)



4 NFC-enabled smartphone or USB card reader ready at hand

To identify yourself online, you need to read out your ID card with a suitable NFC-enabled smartphone or USB card reader.



How to meet the requirements

We explain below how you can put a check mark behind all points mentioned above.

1 - eID function is activated

To be able to identify yourself online, the eID function of your ID card or electronic residence permit must be activated. With the eID card, this is activated automatically.

How do I know if the eID function of my ID card is activated?

There are several ways to find out:

Your ID card was issued after July 2017. In this case, the eID function is also automatically activated for ID cards and electronic residence permits.

You use the "Check device and ID card" feature in AusweisApp on your smartphone and receive a positive result with a green check mark next to "eID function activated".

You go to your local public administration office to check whether the eID function of your ID card has been activated.

What if the eID function of my ID card is deactivated?

For activation, you can contact your local public administration office. You can find out about the opening hours, contact persons and responsibilities of the offices and authorities in your area by calling the public authority hotline 115 or on the Internet: <https://servicesuche.bund.de/#/en>.

2 - self-selected, six-digit PIN is known

Every time you identify yourself online, you must enter your self-selected, six-digit PIN to enable data transmission. If you do not know this PIN, there are several ways to set a PIN:

1. If you have never set a self-selected, six-digit PIN for your ID card and you have your five-digit transport PIN at hand, you can easily and conveniently set a PIN in AusweisApp using the "Change PIN" feature. You will find the five-digit transport PIN in the PIN letter you receive in the mail after you apply for a new ID card.
2. You set a new PIN for your ID card at the public administration office responsible for you. You can find out the opening hours, contact persons and responsibilities of the offices and authorities closest to where you live by calling the public authorities hotline 115 or on the Internet: <https://servicesuche.bund.de/#/en>.

3 - AusweisApp is installed

You can download AusweisApp for your laptop, smartphone and tablet. The possibility to download as well as information about compatible operating systems can be found [here](#)

Direct connection via NFC chip



App on smartphone with
NFC chip as card reader

If you want to visit the website of a provider of the eID function directly via smartphone, it is sufficient to install AusweisApp on your mobile device.

Smartphone als Kartenleser

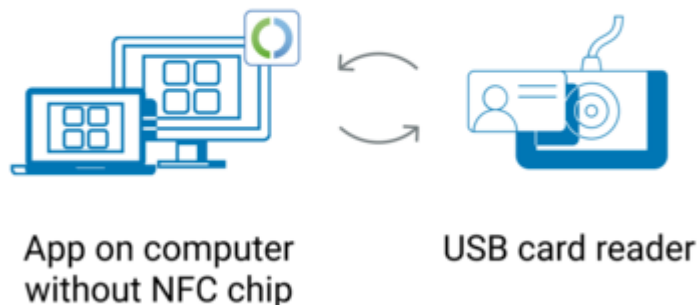


App on computer
without NFC chip

Smartphone with
NFC chip as card
reader

If you want to use your smartphone as a card reader in combination with your laptop, the app must be installed on both of these devices.

USB-Kartenleser



If you use a USB card reader, you only need to install AusweisApp on your PC/laptop.

Notes on tablets

Of course, you can also use AusweisApp on your tablet. A few tablets are equipped with an NFC chip and can be used directly for reading the ID card. With most tablets, however, you have to use your smartphone as a card reader. We explain how this works [here](#)

4 - NFC-enabled smartphone or USB card reader ready to use

To be able to transmit your details to a provider and identify yourself online, you need to read out your ID card. This can be done with suitable, NFC-enabled smartphones or suitable USB card readers.

An overview of suitable smartphones and USB card readers that you can use to read out your ID card can be found [here](#)

Setting up the card reader

Before you can use your **smartphone as a card reader**, you need to set this function up.

Re

How to use the eID Function

Security & Privacy

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